actions use them selectively. In the case of the United States, the war in Afghanistan was a war of response, and the war in Iraq, though perceived as a preventive war, was seen by decision makers in the administration as a "last resort." Many issues in this context are still under discussion:

- What degree of "imminence" has to be present in order to justify a preemptive strike?
- Should the preemptive strike be used as a primary instrument in the war on terror?
- What is the source of the authority that proposes and approves a preemptive strike?
- What is the role of external allies in the decision-making process of a preemptive strike?
- What is the role of the UN and the Security Council?
- Regarding the use of nuclear weapons in the framework of this strategy —is it a yes or a no?

With regard to targeted killings, they developed and reached operational maturation in Israel, through trial and error and on the basis of moral considerations according to which there is complete justification in targeting the terrorist and trying to avoid causing collateral damage as much as possible. However, in order to prevent the proliferation of the use of this measure, it is permitted to be used only against targets defined as "ticking bombs," in the sense that the anticipated attack is imminent and the terrorist is on his or her way to carrying it out. Even in these cases, the approval of the prime minister is required.

The million-dollar question that the average citizen of the world today wants to know with regard to terrorism is: How do we defeat and eliminate it? We must be courageous and respond truthfully— there is no magical solution that can put an end, once and for all, to the phenomenon of terrorism. Having said that, terrorism can certainly be contained and reduced to a level that human society can live with, as it does with disease or road accidents. To this end, the international community must take a large number of steps at the strategic, tactical-operational, and ideological levels.